

U.O.Note No.757/Spl.B/2001-1, Genl.Admn. (Spl.B) Dept., dt.18.07.2001 regarding Vigilance Commission - maintenance of secrecy of files dealing with disciplinary matters, by Departments.

Subject Heading : Vigilance Commission - secrecy of movement of files

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All the Departments of Secretariat are informed that it was brought to the notice of the Government that officers accused of corruption against whom Departmental/criminal proceedings are pending are approaching the Andhra Pradesh Vigilance Commission seeking early clearance of the file referred for its advice. Obviously, officers handling disciplinary matters are disclosing information to the accused officer causing considerable inconvenience and embarrassment to the Commission. This is an undesirable practice.

2. All the Departments of Secretariat are therefore, requested to see that accused officers do not have access to officers handling disciplinary matters in the Department except at the level of the Chief Vigilance Officers. It should also be ensured that the movement of files is not revealed to the accused officer. Advice of the Commission is strictly confidential and even correspondence with the Commission is not to be quoted in any reference of the Department.

3. All the Departments of Secretariat are therefore, requested to follow the above instructions strictly.